



Comments of Amazon
Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

Amazon welcomes the opportunity to respond to the Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP)'s February 6, 2025 [request for information](#) on issues related to the development of an AI Action Plan. U.S. leadership on AI policy is vital to ensure that AI's benefits are realized throughout the economy and society.

As Vice President J.D. Vance said in recent remarks, AI can enable “countless, revolutionary applications in economic innovation, job creation, national security, health care, free expression, and beyond.” Amazon has long believed that AI has the potential to transform every sector of the economy – advancing drug development and the treatment of disease, transforming agriculture and creating efficiencies for businesses of all kinds. This is why Amazon is investing in generative AI and the development and deployment of foundation models across all of our businesses; and why we support and provide resources for our Amazon Web Services (AWS) customers to do the same. Through Amazon Bedrock, we provide customers with access to a wide range of third-party models, in addition to Amazon's own models.

Amazon's perspectives on AI are informed by our dual role as a developer of AI technology and a deployer of AI tools and services. Across Amazon, we've been developing and deploying state of the art AI and machine learning models to power customer experiences for over 25 years—for both customer-facing services and internal operations—from the recommendation engines that personalize the shopping experience on Amazon.com to the AI-powered robots that optimize order fulfillment in our warehouses. We've launched entirely new businesses based on AI, like Alexa, our general purpose, personal AI.

AWS plays a key role in helping organizations across industry sectors leverage AI to improve their productivity, enhance their competitiveness, and better serve their customers. AWS offers the broadest and deepest portfolio of AI and ML services for cloud customers, empowering developers to build, train, and deploy their own ML models or easily incorporate pre-trained AI functionality. From the most performant, scalable infrastructure for ML training and inference to managed API-based capabilities, we provide customers with a broad range of options to help them benefit from AI. The Amazon Bedrock foundation model (FM) service enables customers to experiment with a variety of high-performing FMs from leading AI companies, such as AI21 Labs, Anthropic, Cohere, Meta, Mistral AI, Stability AI, and Amazon itself. Amazon Bedrock allows organizations of all sizes and across industries to find the best FM for their use case, evaluate different models, switch between them, and integrate them into their applications, all in a secure environment. In December 2024, launched Amazon Nova, a new generation of state-of-the-art FMs that deliver frontier intelligence and industry leading price performance. Amazon Nova models include three understanding and two creative content generation models, and can be used to lower costs and latency for almost any generative AI task. Organizations can build on Amazon Nova to analyze complex documents and videos, understand charts and diagrams, generate engaging video content, and build sophisticated AI agents from across a range of intelligence classes optimized for enterprise workloads.

Amazon welcomes the Trump administration's leadership in developing an AI Action Plan to enable

innovation and widespread adoption of AI technologies across industries, create jobs, and drive benefits for all Americans. Our economic and national security interests are best served by policies that enhance technological dynamism and open markets. While U.S. companies have long been the most innovative in the world, such technology leadership cannot be taken for granted. Below, we propose recommendations to ensure that AI innovation will thrive across our own economy, and that U.S. companies will be able to lead on a global scale.

- 1. Promote U.S. technology leadership abroad.** For AI innovation to continue to be driven by U.S. companies, it is vital for the administration to take action to shape the global regulatory environment for AI by partnering with our allies across the globe. Overly restrictive AI regulatory efforts in some jurisdictions could impede AI adoption by capturing low-risk use cases with burdensome regulation, imposing ambiguous regulatory burdens on developers of AI rather than the deployers that are closer to the use-case, extending copyright laws extraterritorially in ways that could constrain American companies from innovating in the U.S. and around the world, and ultimately undermining global interoperability of U.S. AI products and services. We encourage the administration to engage with foreign governments to promote policies that foster innovation, promote competition, and enable the adoption of best-in-class technologies.

Consistent with Vice President Vance's message at the Paris AI Action Summit, it is vital that the AI Action Plan makes clear that the U.S. leadership in AI does not mean that "we want or need to go it alone" and that the U.S. welcomes partnership in the "spirit of openness and collaboration." Indeed, a key element of America's comparative advantage has been that U.S. technology providers are perceived as reliable partners for businesses around the world. It will therefore be very important for the administration to offer an affirmative, pro-competitive vision as it engages with trading partners to address regulatory challenges.

The administration's engagement should also be guided by a recognition that U.S. technological leadership is enhanced through the global partnerships and infrastructure investments of U.S. cloud service providers. AWS is proud to provide infrastructure and cloud services that power the global business community. We are also privileged to provide critical technological support for the national security communities of many of America's most enduring allies. U.S. companies have the most sophisticated and secure technology to host government workloads, which are essential to national security. To support this mission, AWS makes significant investments in the U.S. and in the dozens of countries in which we operate our regions. Maintaining a positive presence in international markets strengthens U.S. global leadership and national security while empowering allied nations. AWS's investments in digital infrastructure, both here and abroad, are long-term capital investments in permanent physical structures that reflect our enduring commitment to business continuity. Our U.S. and international customers rely on AWS, and we are committed to supporting our customers with these investments. As the Administration focuses on ensuring a level playing field for American businesses, it is also imperative that the U.S. government supports the success of American businesses abroad. Thus, it is critical that new technologies like secure generative AI and quantum are built on secure, resilient American cloud technology and infrastructure globally. The Administration should send clear signals to allies and partners that it supports American companies' investments, and will assure their continuity of service to promote their innovation, growth and success abroad. In turn, American

companies want to be treated fairly and not be subject to asymmetric regulations or discriminatory requirements based on their revenue, activity, their nationality or the location of their global headquarters. The Administration should advance reforms that support secure cloud and AI adoption, in the U.S. and allied countries, and avoid discriminatory actions that can disadvantage American companies, hamper innovation and inadvertently lead to less secure and less resilient technology that equally endangers the capacity for businesses to scale internationally.

We therefore encourage the administration should take a leadership role in global discussions around AI, including by promoting global regulatory interoperability through international standards that promote AI adoption. The goal should be to reduce friction for U.S. businesses seeking to operate across jurisdictions by streamlining compliance. Significant work by industry and the U.S. government has already produced important international standards, such as ISO/IEC 42001:2023. In addition to promoting existing standards, federal agencies should be encouraged to work with industry to drive the development of international standards that position U.S. companies for global competitiveness. Success in promoting interoperable global technical standards will be enhanced by continued leadership of our key science agencies, including the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST). NIST's collaboration with industry on the development of the AI Risk Management Framework helped lay the foundation for the "risk-based approach" to AI policymaking.

- 2. Unlock the energy capacity needed to meet growing needs.** Today, capacity on the U.S. electric grid is a major consideration for investment in critical industries. In order to preserve U.S. leadership in generative AI and emerging technologies, the U.S. needs to ensure we have the electric capacity to meet our needs, including additional transmission lines and electricity generation. New investments in transmission and generation infrastructure need to be prioritized, accelerated and permitted in short order to scale with the demands AI workloads require. We support efforts to accelerate and streamline federal permitting for energy infrastructure to build out the American grid quickly to meet business growth for AI and other areas of electrification. We also support rules that expedite the interconnection of new generation that take a holistic view of increasing energy demands. For example, we support reforms to improve the transmission planning and generator interconnection processes and the development of policies enabling co-location of large customers with electric generators.

Nuclear energy will also play a critical role in meeting AI energy demands in the United States. Amazon is investing in nuclear energy, including by signing agreements to enable new small modular reactor (SMR) technologies, investing directly in advanced nuclear companies providing SMR technologies, and supporting existing nuclear facilities to aid their long-term financial health. SMRs are an advanced kind of nuclear reactor with a smaller physical footprint, allowing them to be built closer to the customers they serve. They also have faster build times than traditional reactors, allowing them to come online sooner. However, advanced nuclear projects have not been built at scale and can struggle with traditional financing models. Successful deployment of new technologies like SMRs, carbon capture and storage, and advanced geothermal will require continued federal funding and low-cost loans through the U.S. Department of Energy to support commercial pathways until traditional financing models can

better support them.

3. Invest in the domestic workforce to encourage broad adoption of AI across the U.S. economy.

To secure the benefits of AI across the economy, widespread adoption is as important as innovation. Successful AI deployment—not just breakthrough innovations—creates better jobs, higher wages, and improved living standards. To ensure that the adoption of AI is widespread across the U.S. economy, we believe there is a need for broader workforce education initiatives focused on practical AI implementation rather than just advanced technical training. The U.S. must simultaneously invest in more advanced AI researchers and engineers, as well as enabling millions of workers across different sectors to effectively use AI tools in their daily work.

To help upskill and reskill the workforce in AI development and adoption, AWS committed to provide free training for cloud and AI skills to 29 million people by the end of 2025. In fact, we have exceeded this goal, having already trained 31 million people and counting. In April 2024, Amazon also committed to invest \$25 million over 10 years through a new research partnership with the University of Washington, the University of Tsukuba, and NVIDIA to support new AI research funding, post-doctoral and PhD fellowships, a 10-week undergraduate summer research program, and a three-week entrepreneurship bootcamp program. In 2024, we also launched the [AWS Public Sector Generative Artificial Intelligence Impact Initiative](#). The two-year, \$50 million investment is designed to help public sector organizations—and those that directly support their technology needs—to accelerate innovation in support of critical missions using AWS generative AI services and infrastructure. [AWS's AI and ML Scholarship Program](#) has awarded \$28 million in scholarships to approximately 6,000 students to prepare them for a career in AI. Through our AI Ready campaign, Amazon is committed to providing free AI training to two million people, focusing on practical skills that enable workers to leverage AI solutions without requiring advanced degrees in computer science.

We encourage the administration to similarly prioritize broad-based AI literacy programs that can accelerate adoption across the economy, and particularly small and medium-sized businesses. Such programs should focus on helping business leaders identify AI opportunities, enabling workers to effectively use AI tools, and ensuring small businesses have the knowledge needed to successfully implement AI solutions. This approach to AI skills development - emphasizing practical implementation over purely technical training - will be critical to ensuring U.S. leadership in AI translates into economy-wide productivity gains and corresponding global leadership.

4. Enable AI to bolster national security and defense. U.S. leadership in AI is critical to American national security interests. Maintaining AI leadership in national security and defense requires increased and sustained AI infrastructure investment in government-specific and classified environments. The U.S. government should prioritize use of AI capabilities available through commercial cloud technologies. For example, Amazon Bedrock is now generally available in the [AWS Top Secret cloud](#). With [authority to operate in the AWS Top Secret cloud](#), Amazon Bedrock is providing U.S. government customers with secure access to foundation models and generative AI capabilities within AWS's classified environment, enabling customers to leverage generative AI capabilities while maintaining the highest levels of security and data protection

required for their top-secret workloads.

The U.S. Government should also seek to advance AI adoption in the U.S. national security community. By providing public sector users access to AI tools, they can better understand and iterate on how AI can further the U.S. national security and defense missions. Industry would be better positioned to provide the capacity the community needs with clearer demand signals from the government, including clearer requirements, and increased adoption, while also adding resilience and elasticity. Strong adoption also helps companies rapidly deploy and adjust AI systems to meet mission needs on the correct infrastructure.

The US government should also consider how to leverage AI to address risks to national security, such as how AI can support efforts to enhance cyber defense. Additional research and collaboration between the administration and the private sector would be fruitful in this important area.

- 5. Unlock AI's potential within the public sector.** Rapid progress in AI presents an opportunity for transformative innovation across the public sector. Cloud is uniquely effective in enabling modernization while supporting new entrants to the public sector AI ecosystem. By leveraging innovative commercial offerings such as marketplaces for cloud-native applications, managed services, and hardware, agencies gain access to responsive AI innovation. The administration should encourage agencies to use existing best practices in technology contracting to ensure efficiency and responsible innovation across federal agencies. Further, agencies should migrate away from legacy, on-premises data centers in order to take advantage of cloud capabilities. Current regulatory procedures for commercial contracting enable flexible procurement of AI and government purchasing officials should be directed to use these methods to the greatest extent practicable. The administration's AI emphasis can reinvigorate use of commercial acquisition methods throughout federal agencies.

Cloud migration has become a cornerstone for federal agencies seeking to modernize their digital operations and unlock mission success while cutting costs. By shifting from legacy on-premises infrastructure to scalable cloud solutions, agencies can reduce costs, increase operational agility, and meet evolving mission demands with greater speed and efficiency. Beyond cost savings, cloud migration enables federal agencies to deliver on their core missions with unprecedented efficiency. Modern AI and data analytics solutions deployed in the cloud allow agencies to harness real-time insights and automate processes, ultimately improving public services and national security outcomes. For example, the U.S. Air Force provides a compelling example of how AI-driven solutions can enhance mission readiness. By leveraging predictive maintenance solutions powered by AWS and C3 AI, the U.S. Air Force uses AI algorithms and data analytics to monitor operations, detect anomalies, and predict potential equipment failures before they occur. This proactive approach helps reduce downtime and ensures more aircraft are ready for flight, improving operational availability while lowering maintenance costs. We encourage the administration to empower federal agencies to increase velocity of AI adoption across civilian, defense, and intelligence mission areas.

6. **Ensure existing regulation remains fit for purpose.** Amazon has long been a supporter of a sectoral approach to AI regulation, acknowledging that a prescriptive, “horizontal” approach is unlikely to be effective, may create unnecessary burdens for innovation, and would ignore robust legal frameworks already in place. We urge the administration to ensure that agencies charged with enforcing existing technology-neutral laws and sector-specific regulations are equipped to oversee the use of AI within their domains.

Organizations develop and deploy AI systems against the backdrop of an array of existing laws and regulatory requirements that help protect the public against potential unintended consequences. Nonetheless, there may be areas in which AI will raise novel questions that may require adjustments to existing laws and regulations. A sector-based approach will empower existing agencies to identify real gaps in legislation and regulation, avoiding redundancy and over-regulation.

One emerging area of regulatory difficulty that could impede the competitiveness of U.S. industry is the growing patchwork of approaches to AI regulation across the U.S. states, which has the potential to create a significant headwind for US innovation, as businesses struggle to comply with a variety of diverging standards. In the absence of a clearly articulated federal vision about how AI should be governed, there is a substantial risk that states will seek to fill the perceived void.

7. **Encourage the development of appropriate risk-based governance practices in the private sector.** Amazon and other U.S. companies are engaged in significant efforts to build AI with robust governance mechanisms to address AI risk. Through organizations such as the Frontier Model Forum, the Partnership on AI, and others, companies are developing best practices regarding prevention of risk in AI development. Given the geopolitical significance of frontier capabilities, we recommend that the administration maintain government capacity to collaborate with the private sector on a voluntary basis to evaluate advanced models for potential national security risks. Maintaining a pathway for public-private collaboration will help advance the science behind capability evaluations, for national security risks, including the potential that models might aid the development of chemical, biological, radiological and nuclear (CBRN) and advanced cyber threats. We believe the U.S. government has an important role to play in ongoing engagement with industry on our work in risk mitigation of this kind, through convenings, sharing best practices, and encouraging the private sector to adopt appropriate governance-based risk-mitigation practices. U.S. government leadership in this space is also vital for shaping global norms at a time when foreign governments are investing heavily in building out their own AI national security evaluation capabilities.
8. **Support the National Artificial Intelligence Research Resource (NAIRR).** In his January 23 Executive Order launching the President’s Council of Advisors on Science and Technology, President Trump recognized the important research and innovations that initiatives like the National Science Foundation’s NAIRR can advance. The need for a large-scale collaborative research resource has become more pressing as the data and computational resources required for cutting edge AI research continues to grow. We regard the NAIRR as an important opportunity to ensure academic and government researchers have access the fundamental

building blocks that are necessary for modern AI research. Amazon is a contributing partner and pledged to support at least 20 research projects through access to AWS services to build, train and deploy AI models.

The credits donated by technology developers for NAIRR will conclude at the end of the two-year pilot. We encourage the administration and Congress to enable scientists access to the resources they need to develop transformational AI solutions and address many of society's greatest challenges by advancing the NAIRR Task Force recommendations on project support.